

Redesign the feed: who gets seen?

FIVE 70-MINUTE CLASSES · 5–9 OCTOBER 2026



AI-generated conceptual illustration; not a photograph, platform screenshot or case evidence.

Trace a recommendation mechanism, examine real source evidence and defend a qualified judgement about engagement, discovery and user control.

Reading: 3.1 pp. 72–74; 3.2 pp. 86–89; 4.2 pp. 213–219. Monday retrieves pp. 81–85.

The core retains this week's original questions. Appendices supply the chapter review, bounded real cases and explicit partial Paper 1 / Paper 2 practice. Later extensions are labelled; do not complete every question this week.

Evidence: independent traces and explanations, source comparison, consequence chain, teacher observation/conversation and the existing scored quiz/retry. Supports and guided completion remain separate from achievement.

Teacher review draft · 5–9 October 2026 · Original practice, not an official IB examination. No publication or submission occurs from this file.

Start here

In Week 5 you ranked four clips for one invented viewer. Now you will run a whole recommender: many items, related tables, two objectives and a feedback loop. Then you will judge who gains and who loses when the objective changes.

The question for these eight lessons

THIS WEEK · 5–9 OCTOBER 2026

Real inquiry: how should a feed balance engagement, discovery and user control? Investigate TikTok's stated system and the EU's preliminary finding, then use YouTube revenue rules to test what visibility can imply.

Chapters: 3.1H/start 3.1I pp. 72–74; 3.2E pp. 86–89; 4.2A/B pp. 213–219. Monday retrieves pp. 81–85.

[Begin with the visual deck](#) · [Chapter review](#) · [Bounded real-world evidence](#) · [How the 15-section sprint template fits](#)

The original questions and saved-answer fields below remain the main workbook. do7–do9 continue on 13–15 October, matching the local plan.

Who benefits when a feed optimizes attention — and what changes if it optimizes discovery instead?

Your route

Lesson	Planned slot (provisional)	Focus	What happens to your work
ibds-26-so3-d10	Mon 5 Oct	Trace, search, sort and filter a small dataset + your fresh Sprint 2 transfer attempt (20 min)	Traces checked · feedback; Sprint 2 retry scored /8
ibds-26-so3-d03	Tue 6 Oct	Run the Loopline recommender under two settings	Checked in class · feedback
ibds-26-so3-d04	Wed 7 Oct	Feedback loops, big data and the people behind the feed	Collected with the workbook · feedback
ibds-26-so3-d05	Thu 8 Oct	Weekly quiz (/12) + amplification paragraph	Quiz scored /12 · paragraph gets feedback, no mark
ibds-26-so3-d06	Fri 9 Oct	Money, culture and access	Collected with the workbook · feedback
ibds-26-so3-d07	Tue 13 Oct	Provider claims vs regulator findings	Source synthesis collected · feedback, no mark
ibds-26-so3-d08	Wed 14 Oct	Redesign practice + independent transfer	Transfer scored /8 · feedback
ibds-26-so3-d09	Thu 15 Oct	Weekly quiz (/12) + defend your rule + network dependency	Quiz scored /12 · defence observed, no mark

Dates follow the current plan and may move with the school calendar. No formal IA time is used in these lessons.

Reading (printed textbook pages)

- By Thu 8 Oct: pp. 86–89 (algorithmic dilemmas, bias, black box, transparency), pp. 72–74 (big data and the 4Vs), pp. 213–219 (business, work and platforms). Read the explanations and diagrams; the embedded activities are optional.
- By Thu 15 Oct: pp. 220–227 (automation, e-commerce, currencies, globalization) and pp. 31–32 (types of change).

Loopline is invented

Loopline is a fictional short-video platform created for these lessons. Its creators, viewer, numbers and ranking rule are synthetic. It helps you see a mechanism clearly. It is not TikTok's or anyone else's real algorithm, and its numbers are not measurements of real people.

Help you may use

In practice tasks you may use the shared Learning Studio Coach to clarify vocabulary, check your understanding of a step, or ask about your own attempt. Copy the context line from the page you are working on. The Coach does not receive anything automatically.

Open the Learning Studio Coach  (<https://gemini.google.com/gem/1ySXJPfNyohCfESu8EzsD3vuexPiuKQKo?usp=sharing>)

Not allowed with any AI or Coach: the weekly quizzes, the independent transfer task, and writing your source synthesis or judgments for you. Your approved access arrangements always stay in place.

Downloads

- loopline-items.csv, loopline-creators.csv, loopline-user.csv — the related tables
- Loopline_Model.xlsx — spreadsheet version with editable weights (open in Google Sheets or Excel)
- trace-templates.csv — blank trace tables to print or fill
- feedback-loop.svg, network-path.svg, platform-labour.svg — editable diagrams
- source-grid.csv — for the source synthesis lesson

70 MIN · 5 RETRIEVAL + QUIZ REPAIR · 12 TEACHING · 10 GUIDED LAB · 15 INDEPENDENT TRACE
· 20 SPRINT 2 RETRY · 8 FEEDBACK

Trace, search and sort

Search finds. Sort orders. Filter removes. Each does a different job — and each can give a wrong answer if the data is represented badly. Today also includes your fresh attempt at the Sprint 2 transfer.

HOOK

You are the feed designer

A new creator and a familiar creator earn the same score. You have ten seconds: who should appear first?

The familiar creator

The new creator

Use a transparent tie rule

Vote first, then reveal the value inside your choice.

Then: Name the value hidden inside your choice: engagement, discovery, fairness, predictability or something else.

Retrieval and quiz repair · 5 minutes

1. Correct one item from your Week 5 concepts quiz and say why the correction is right. 2. Loophole stores watch time in whole seconds. Is that an analogue or a digital representation, and what detail could be lost? 3. Name one technical part and one social part of a recommendation system.

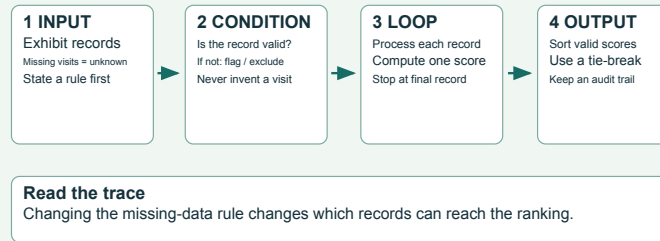
Explicit teaching · 12 minutes

2026-10-05 · Retrieve → trace → independent retry

Start with slides 1–5. Read the algorithm diagram; distinguish search, filter and sort. Trace the parallel museum example, then use Trace Lab after a hand prediction. Preserve 20 minutes for the teacher-held Sprint 2 retry. The clip replaces guided-lab time; skip it if the trace needs reteaching.

An algorithm has more than a score

Parallel museum example · synthetic · retrieve textbook pp. 81–85



Original teaching schematic · Museum input records pass a validity condition, a finite record-processing loop and a sort with a tie-break

Museum input records pass a validity condition, a finite record-processing loop and a sort with a tie-break. Missing data must have a declared policy.

Read the visual: Why does the filter make three comparisons when the search makes one? What would change if the first art record moved to the end?

▼ Parallel example, observable check and repair

Different case: museum records R1 art .4, R2 science .9, R3 art .7. A linear search for science checks R1 then R2 and stops: 2 comparisons. One descending swap pass gives R2,R3,R1. Missing completion may be flagged for a declared default; that is a design choice, not a measurement.

What you should see: the search trace names each inspected record and stops; a sorting pass names comparisons and swaps. Stuck? Write the current list after each swap, and never divide by zero.

Real case: [sources A, C, Y and L](#). Keep source claims separate from model inference.

Timing: retrieval and quiz repair 5 min · explicit teaching 12 min · guided search sort filter 10 min · independent trace application 15 min · fresh transfer retry 20 min · feedback and transition 8 min

Return: use the original response boxes in this lesson; do not re-enter the same response in another page.

Operation	Job	Loopline example	Stops when
Linear search	Find the first item that meets a condition	Find the first science item	A match is found or the list ends
Sort	Put items in order by a value	Order items by a value, highest first	A full pass makes no swaps
Filter	Keep only items that meet a condition	Show only clips of 30 seconds or less	Every item has been checked once

Representation matters. A computer compares exact values: "Football " (capital F, trailing space) is not the same text as "football". Missing values need a stated rule: treating "no data yet" as zero is a design decision, not a neutral fact. A length of zero must be excluded before any division.

VIDEO

How algorithms manipulate you (and how to fight back)

TEACHER TO PREVIEW

CHANNEL

TED · Jen Golbeck and Shalini Kantayya

FULL LENGTH

9:38

WATCH

0:00–3:42 (3:42)

ACCESS

TED transcript and captions available

[Open verified video metadata and clip ↗](#)

While you watch

1. When does a recommendation feel useful rather than manipulative?
2. Who controls the data used to personalize?
3. What human decision should not be delegated?

After: Connect one claim from the clip to an input, objective or rule in the Loopline model.

Meet the Loopline tables

Loopline stores data in related tables. Items and Creators share the field `creator_id`. The viewer profile below is for one synthetic viewer. Keep these tables: you will use them all fortnight.

item_id	creator_id	topic (raw text)	length_s	avg_watch_s	age_days
V01	K1	cooking	40	32	5
V02	K2	football	20	18	1
V03	K4	science	30	21	1
V04	K1	cooking	60	30	3
V05	K5	music	25	20	6
V06	K3	football	50	20	2

item_id	creator_id	topic (raw text)	length_s	avg_watch_s	age_days
V07	K6	art	40	—	0
V08	K7	science	20	15	4
V09	K2	'Football '	30	27	8
V10	K8	language learning	45	36	2
V11	K5	music	0	0	1

creator_id	handle	home country	joined (days ago)
K1	kitchen_kasia	Canada	900
K2	bola_bruno	Brazil	700
K3	pitchside_priya	United Kingdom	1200
K4	lab_wanjiru	Kenya	21
K5	tala_tunes	Philippines	400
K6	trazo_mateo	Mexico	9
K7	orbit_anika	India	35
K8	palabra_lucia	Canada	14

Viewer profile field	Value
user_id	U-ARI (synthetic)
recent topics	cooking, football
creators already watched	K1, K2, K3

Field definitions: length_s = clip length in seconds; avg_watch_s = average seconds watched per view so far (— means no views yet); age_days = days since upload; joined = days since the creator joined Loopline.

Guided lab • 10 minutes • with your teacher

Trace 1 • 4 minutes. Linear search the Items table in order for the first item whose topic is science. Record each comparison. Then predict: how many comparisons for art, and for history? What does the search return when there is no match?

Search trace (comparison number • item • topic • match?) and your predictions

Trace 2 • 6 minutes. Take the first five items (V01–V05) and their avg_watch_s values: V01 32 • V02 18 • V03 21 • V04 30 • V05 20. Run bubble sort to put them in descending order of avg_watch_s. In each pass, compare neighbours from left to right and swap if the left value is smaller. Record every comparison and swap. Stop after a pass with no swaps.

Each pass: comparisons, swaps, list after the pass • when did it stop and why?

Independent trace • 15 minutes • on your own

Filter the Items table to clips of 30 seconds or less. Which items remain? What should happen to V11? Then do the representation check. The viewer's recent topics include football. Look at Vo9's raw topic text: what would an exact-text comparison decide, and what rule fixes it? Finally, Vo7 has no views yet. Compare treating it as 0 with giving it a default of 0.50. Which is fairer to a new creator, and what is the risk?

Filtered list and your decision about V11

Vo9 decision and fix • Vo7 options and your stated assumption • how one of these choices could change what a viewer sees

Checkpoint: compare with a partner only after you have written your own answer. If your answers differ, find the exact step where they differ.

Fresh Sprint 2 transfer attempt • 20 minutes • collected

Before this lesson you received feedback on your 29 September independent transfer. Reread your one next action. Your teacher will then hand out a fresh, unseen parallel task (assessment ibds-26-so2-do8, second attempt). Work alone, closed-book, with no AI or Coach. Approved access arrangements apply. Your first attempt is kept; this is a new, separately dated attempt.

Evidence: your traces and error correction with a stated assumption are checked with feedback (no mark). The Sprint 2 fresh attempt is scored /8 as a new attempt under ibds-26-so2-do8. It is excluded from predicted component grades.

Run the Loopline recommender

One equation. Two sets of weights. Watch the order change — and ask whose content becomes visible.

Retrieval · 5 minutes

In a Loopline row, which fields are data about the viewer’s behaviour and which are metadata about the clip? How does 32 seconds watched (data) become a completion rate (information) and then a claim about interest (knowledge)?

The ranking equation · 12 minutes

2026-10-06 · Signals → changed objective → visibility

Start with slides 6–10. Compare TikTok’s historical stated signals with the synthetic Loopline model. Join on keys; predict a weight change before revealing calculations. Explain one numerical mover and one stakeholder consequence. Paper 1b is the visibility-phase rehearsal, using your own trace; the original independent feedback-loop prompt stays in its 15-minute block.

From signals to a feed

TikTok states these categories in June 2020; current weights are undisclosed.

INPUTS

Interactions: watching, liking
Video: captions, sounds, tags
Account/device: language
Completion is not a motive

PROCESS

Predict possible interest
Weight and rank candidates
Apply eligibility/safety rules
Diversify recommendations

OUTPUT

Ordered recommendations
Some items remain unseen
People choose goals
People can contest results

Original teaching schematic · Interactions, video information and account settings enter ranking and filtering

Interactions, video information and account settings enter ranking and filtering. An ordered feed appears. Human objectives and controls shape it; the provider description does not disclose current weights.

Read the visual:

Use the two museum scores to explain the reversal. Does the higher score establish that M2 is a better video? Why?

▼ Parallel example, observable check and repair

Different case: museum M1 $c=.8, m=1$; M2 $c=.9, m=0$. Under $c+2m$ scores are 2.8 and .9. Under $3c+.2m$ they are 2.6 and 2.7. The changed priority reverses their order; no conclusion about income follows from these scores.

What you should see: a score for each eligible item and a reproducible descending order. Stuck? Check length, topic normalization, the selected setting and ties: higher c, then ascending item_id.

Real case: [sources A, C, Y and L](#). Keep source claims separate from model inference.

Timing: retrieval 5 min · explicit teaching 12 min · inquiry or lab 30 min · independent application 15 min · feedback and transition 8 min

Return: use the original response boxes in this lesson; do not re-enter the same response in another page.

$$\text{score} = a \times c + b \times m + d \times f + e \times n$$

Variable	Meaning	How to calculate
c	completion rate	$\text{avg_watch_s} \div \text{length_s}$ (a decimal from 0 to 1). No views yet: use 0.50 and flag it. $\text{length_s} \leq 0$: exclude the item.
m	topic match	1 if the normalised topic is in the viewer's recent topics; otherwise 0
f	freshness	1 if $\text{age_days} \leq 2$; otherwise 0
n	novelty	1 if the viewer has not watched this creator before; otherwise 0

Setting	a (c)	b (m)	d (f)	e (n)
E · Engagement	3	2	1	0
D · Discovery	3	1	1	2

Tie rule: if two scores are equal, the item with the higher completion rate goes first; if still tied, the lower item_id goes first.

Worked example on a different item (not in the Loopline table): an item with $c = 0.60$, $m = 1$, $f = 0$, $n = 1$ scores $3 \times 0.60 + 2 \times 1 + 1 \times 0 + 0 \times 1 = 3.80$ under E, and $3 \times 0.60 + 1 \times 1 + 1 \times 0 + 2 \times 1 = 4.80$ under D.

Lab · 30 minutes

12 minutes: complete the trace for every valid item under Setting E. Show c, m, f and n, then the score. Use the spreadsheet only to check your hand calculations.

item_id	c	m	f	n	score E	score D
V01						
V02						
V03						
V04						
V05						
V06						

item_id	c	m	f	n	score E	score D
V07						
V08						
V09						
V10						

Your ranking under Setting E (highest first), with any flags

10 minutes: calculate scores under Setting D and rank again. Mark which items move up or down by three or more places.

Your ranking under Setting D and the biggest movers

8 minutes: which creators gain visibility in the top three under D, and which lose it? Use creator IDs and home countries from the Creators table.

Who gains and who loses the top three?

Checkpoint: the top item under E and under D. Your teacher will confirm both before you continue. If yours differ, recheck c for that item and the tie rule.

Independent application • 15 minutes

Explain how a feedback loop could change tomorrow’s inputs. Suppose today’s top three items are shown to many more viewers than the rest. What new data does each group of items produce, and how could that change tomorrow’s scores?

Evidence: your ranked results under both settings and the recorded variable change. Checked in class with feedback. No mark.

SIMULATION

Tune the Feed

Prompt source: S3 · Feed ranking lab (IBDS Sprint 3: Data, algorithms and recommendation)

Open this only after completing the hand calculation. It must use the separate Snapcast dataset from AI_STUDIO_PROMPTS.md.

Ready. It works offline and collects no data.

[Open Tune the Feed ↗](#)

Return to the workbook: What moved when you changed the goal, and which term in the score caused that movement?

SELF CHECK

Quick self-check

1. Which variable represents completion rate? _____

c

m

f

2. What happens when length is zero or negative? _____

Use 0.50

Exclude the row

Rank it last

3. After scores tie, what is checked first? _____

Freshness

Completion rate

Creator country

Unmarked. Misses stay in this workbook's local "Things I got wrong" list and are included in the journal hand-off.

Feedback, scale and the people behind the feed

A feed learns from what it shows. Items it never shows produce no new evidence. And behind every feed are people, often in other countries, doing the work.

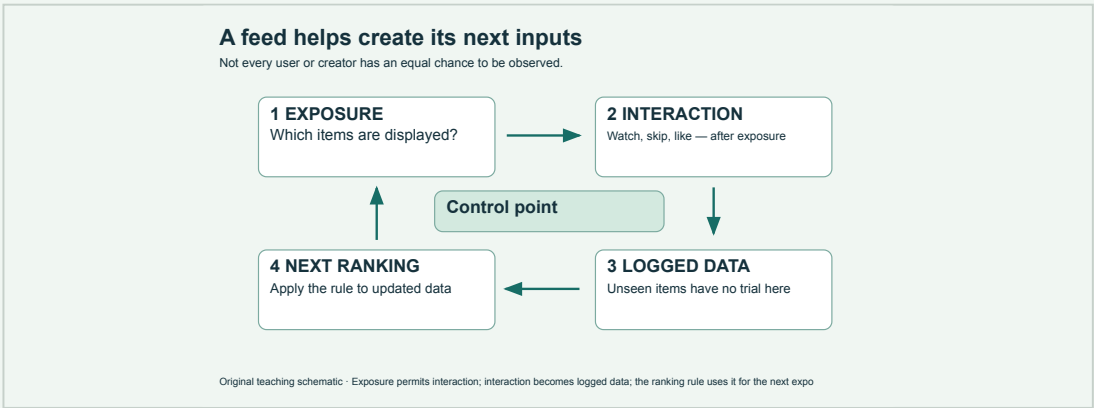
Retrieval · 5 minutes

Every model leaves things out. Name one thing the Loopleftine equation includes and one thing it omits. Why is “no data yet” not evidence that an item is bad?

Explicit teaching · 12 minutes

2026-10-07 · Four Vs → feedback → platform work

Start with slides 11–15. Review the four data characteristics and collection dilemma. Predict two rounds before Roundtable. Compare A and C’s scope. Use L as a broader labour lens. Watch the historical TED excerpt within the lab, then evaluate whether discovery alone addresses the modelled problem.



Exposure permits interaction; interaction becomes logged data; the ranking rule uses it for the next exposure. Unseen content lacks an equivalent opportunity. A discovery slot changes exposure.

Read the visual: Locate the point where an unseen creator gets no new evidence. What intervention could interrupt that loop without changing every score?

▼ Parallel example, observable check and repair

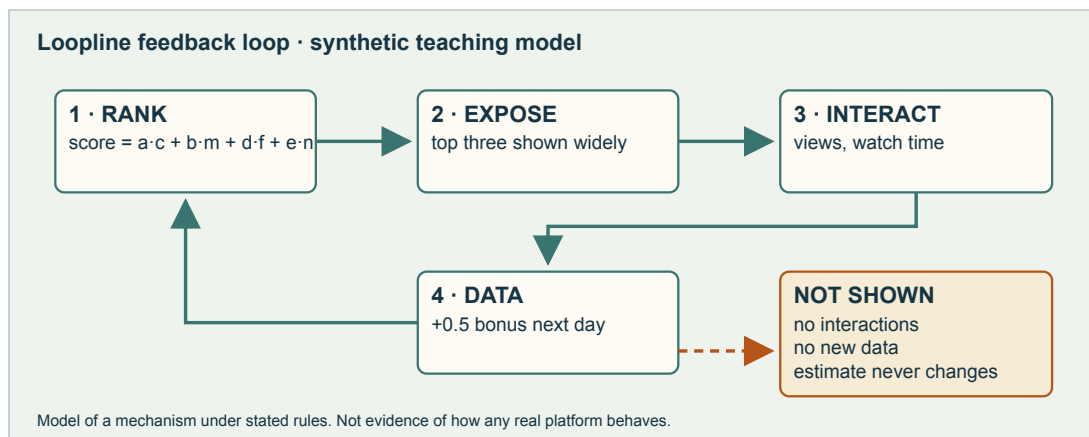
Different case: museum exhibit A starts at 4, B at 3. Showing A and adding 2 gives A=6; showing A again gives A=8. This reveals feedback under an invented bonus rule. It does not establish that a real audience was persuaded or that designers intended harm.

What you should see: the displayed item gets the bonus, not every item. Stuck? Label the current versus next-round scores. Keep clean/small (20 complete records) and messy/large (200 records, 60 duplicated, 40 without exposure context) distinct; state what you would check before combining them.

Real case: [sources A, C, Y and L](#). Keep source claims separate from model inference.

Timing: retrieval 5 min · explicit teaching 12 min · inquiry or lab 30 min · independent application 15 min · feedback and transition 8 min

Return: use the original response boxes in this lesson; do not re-enter the same response in another page.



Loop: ranking decides exposure; exposure produces interactions; interactions become data; data changes tomorrow's ranking. Items never shown produce no new interactions, so their scores never change. Original editable diagram (SVG in the asset download).

The 4Vs (textbook pp. 72–73)	In a real feed	Loopline's tiny table
Volume	Very large amounts of data created every day	11 rows — far too small to show volume
Velocity	Speed at which data is generated, collected and analysed	We rank once per "day"; real feeds update continuously
Variety	Many types and formats of data	Only numbers and short text here
Veracity	Accuracy and quality of the data	V09's messy topic text and V11's zero length are veracity problems

VIDEO

Beware online ‘filter bubbles’

TEACHER TO PREVIEW

CHANNEL

TED · Eli Pariser

FULL LENGTH

9:05

WATCH

0:45–4:05 (3:20)

ACCESS

TED transcript and captions available

[Open verified video metadata and clip ↗](#)

While you watch

1. What did the platform remove without asking?
2. What data might have driven that choice?
3. Who gains control when filtering is invisible?

After: Draw one reinforcing loop from a click to a narrower future feed.

Lab A • the feedback-loop simulation • 18 minutes

Rules. Each day: rank all valid items. The top three are shown widely. Each time an item is shown, it earns a +0.5 interaction bonus added to its score on all later days. Every item gets one day older each day, so freshness can expire. Items that are not shown get no bonus and no new data.

Day	Setting E top three	Setting D top three	Notes (ties, freshness changes)
1			
2			
3			

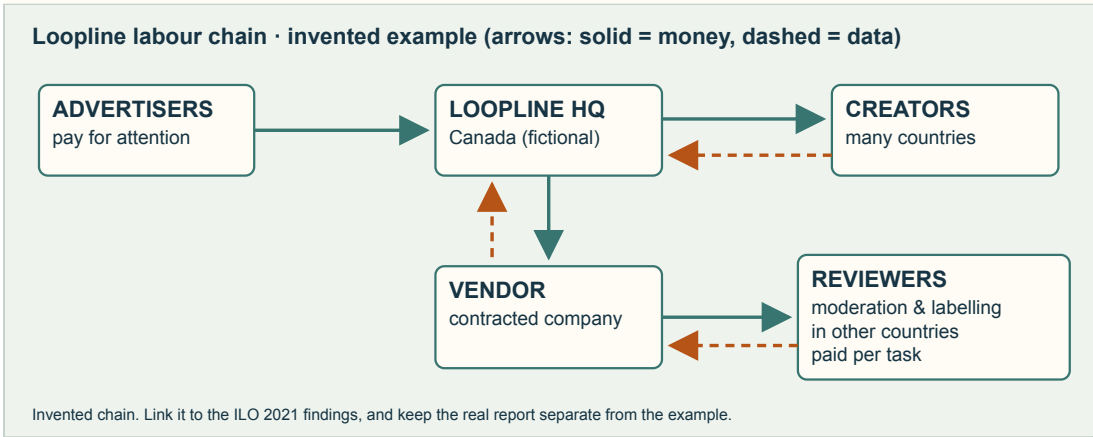
Which items were never shown under E? What happened to Vo7’s evidence? Does Setting D escape the loop, or create a different one?

A simulation shows how a mechanism could behave under stated rules. It is not evidence that any real platform behaves this way.

Lab B • people behind the feed • 12 minutes

Source window • International Labour Organization, 23 February 2021. The ILO’s 2021 flagship report found that digital labour platforms had grown about five-fold in a decade. It reported that much of the work on online web-based platforms comes from richer countries but is done by workers in the global South, who often earn much less. It also reported that about half of online platform workers earned under US\$2 an hour, and that algorithms increasingly allocate and evaluate work.

ILO news release, 23 February 2021 ↗ (<https://www.ilo.org/resource/news/rapid-growth-digital-economy-calls-coherent-policy-response-o>)



Synthetic Loopline labour chain: platform headquarters contracts a vendor; the vendor employs content reviewers and data labellers in other countries; creators upload; advertisers pay; viewers watch. Arrows show money and data moving between them. Original editable diagram (SVG in the asset download).

Loopline’s labour chain is invented. Use the diagram to trace one flow of money and one flow of data across a border. Then connect the chain to one ILO finding. Keep clear which parts are the real report and which are the invented example.

One money flow, one data flow across a border, and one ILO finding linked to a stakeholder effect

Independent application · 15 minutes

Explain how a feedback loop can shift visibility towards some creators. Use your simulation, and state one thing the simulation cannot tell us about real platforms. Then use one of the 4Vs to explain why real feeds are harder to audit than Loopleft.

Evidence: feedback-loop diagram and table, labour-chain trace and your explanation. Collected with the workbook, with focused feedback. No mark.

Weekly quiz and amplification

First, the weekly quiz on paper. Then an important distinction: a feed can amplify a pattern without anybody intending it — and a correlation alone does not show intent or cause.

Weekly quiz · 12 minutes + 5 minutes correction

Your teacher hands out the quiz. It has ten items (/12) and covers this week's reading plus four items from earlier learning. Work alone, closed-book, with no AI or Coach. Your approved access arrangements apply. After collection, correct your own copy in a different colour. Write why each correction is right.

Explicit teaching · 8 minutes

2026-10-08 · Quiz → dilemmas → independent explanation

Start with slides 16–20 after the registered quiz and correction. Review bias, opacity and accountability; distinguish a pattern from intent. In the 25-minute lab, locate a claim in A and C and connect it to the trace. The original do5 Paper 1 paragraph stays separately formative.

Do not skip the evidence between claims

A recorded pattern does not reveal a designer's intention.

OBSERVATION

What did the log record?
Exposure and interactions
Who was absent?

MECHANISM

How might a rule explain it?
Identify a changed operation
Test an alternative explanation

INTENT / IMPACT

Intent: objective documents?
Impact: suitable outcome data?
A model cannot establish either

Impact → implication

Immediate consequence for a named group → why it matters under stated conditions.
Example: more chances to see an exhibit → possibly wider cultural access.
Missing evidence: attendance, sustained access, audience and income.

Original teaching schematic - Observation can support a pattern; a mechanism explanation needs a rule; claims of intent need evidence o

Observation can support a pattern; a mechanism explanation needs a rule; claims of intent need evidence of objectives and decisions. An implication needs a supported impact and stated conditions.

Read the visual: What does the observation support, what does the model explain, and what additional evidence would be needed to claim deliberate manipulation?

▼ Parallel example, observable check and repair

Different case: a museum changes from topic priority to completion priority. “M2 becomes first because its .9 completion now contributes 2.7 points, exceeding M1’s 2.6.” This explains a mechanism. “Visitors must prefer M2” overstates what the data establish.

What you should see: a connected explanation with an intermediate operation and a case-specific result. Stuck? Point to the row or arrow your sentence explains. Replace “the algorithm did it” with the operation.

Real case: [sources A, C, Y and L](#). Keep source claims separate from model inference.

Timing: quiz and correction 17 min · explicit teaching 8 min · inquiry or lab 25 min · independent application 15 min · transition 5 min

Return: use the original response boxes in this lesson; do not re-enter the same response in another page.

Claim	What it needs
Correlation	Two things change together (e.g. topics shown more often also get more watch time)
Cause	Evidence that changing one thing changes the other, with other explanations ruled out
Amplification	A mechanism (like the loop) that makes an existing pattern bigger
Intent	Evidence about the designer’s purpose — the output alone cannot show this

Lab · 25 minutes · amplification investigation

Scenario (synthetic): after three days under Setting E, football and cooking make up almost all of the Loopline viewer’s top-three feed. A classmate says, “Loopline deliberately hides science creators.”

Using your Day 1–3 table, explain the mechanism that produced the pattern. Where does the evidence show amplification? Which representation makes it clearest: a table of scores, or a chart of who was shown each day? Why?

What evidence would you need before accepting the claim about deliberate hiding? Name two kinds of evidence and say why the ranking output alone is not enough.

Independent application · 15 minutes · Paper 1 practice

Practice question (feedback only, no mark): Explain why an engagement-optimized recommendation loop may amplify a pattern in what users see. [4]

Success criteria: name the mechanism accurately (exposure → interactions → data → ranking); connect each step with a cause; use one specific example from your simulation; qualify your claim so it does not assert intent from correlation.

Your Paper 1 explanation

Evidence: quiz ibds-26-so3-d05 scored /12 (eight multiple choice + two short responses confirmed by your teacher). The paragraph gets written feedback and no mark; it is not added to the /12.

SELF CHECK

Quick self-check

1. What does amplification change first? _____

Visibility

Truth

Legality

2. A reinforcing loop does what? _____

Cancels change

Strengthens an initial advantage

Removes all bias

3. Which is evidence about a mechanism? _____

The feed is bad

Top three receive ten times more views

Everyone dislikes it

Unmarked. Misses stay in this workbook's local "Things I got wrong" list and are included in the journal hand-off.

Visibility is worth money. A platform's revenue model shapes what its ranking rewards — and a ranking rule travels, from video feeds to learning platforms.

Define microtargeting in one sentence. Which Loopline creators lost top-three visibility under Setting D?

Start with slides 21–25. Review business operations/diversification, hiring and digital work. Read Y's percentages with their different bases. During the 30-minute inquiry, use Paper 2 Q1–Q3 as the source-comparison sequence. Prioritize Q3, then write the original d06 consequence chain independently. The /12 synthesis extension is for a later lesson.

Watch page ads pay 55 percent of net ad revenue; Shorts pay 45 percent of the allocated Creator Pool share. The 100-unit examples are synthetic and cannot predict a creator income.

Different case: a museum exposes more local-language exhibits. Immediate impact: more opportunities to encounter them. Possible implication: sustained access could support cultural visibility. Ticket or audience data would be needed to infer increased income. Global reach can help access while still favouring dominant-language material.

What you should see: one claim traceable to each source and a relationship between them. Stuck? Use the section heading and paragraph opening; distinguish “provider states”, “regulator preliminarily finds” and “I infer”.

Real case: sources A, C, Y and L. Keep source claims separate from model inference.

Timing: retrieval 5 min · explicit teaching 12 min · inquiry or lab 30 min · independent application 15 min · feedback and transition 8 min

Return: use the original response boxes in this lesson; do not re-enter the same response in another page.

Many free platforms earn money from advertising. More attention means more ad views, which is one reason engagement objectives are attractive to platforms. Some platforms share ad revenue with creators, so ranking also redistributes income.

Source window · YouTube Help, “YouTube partner earnings overview” (undated page, checked 27 September 2026). For creators in its partner programme, YouTube states it pays 55% of net revenue from ads shown on their public long-form videos. For Shorts it pays 45% of the revenue allocated to them, based on their share of views in a creator pool. This is one platform’s stated policy, not a rule for all platforms.

YouTube partner earnings overview ↗ (<https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/72902>)

Lab · 30 minutes · three linked cases

Case 1 · creator income (10 minutes). Suppose Loopline paid creators 50% of ad revenue from their views, and each top-three slot earned about 1,000 extra views per day. These are synthetic assumptions. Compare which creators would earn more under E and under D. Build a chain: ranking objective → visibility → income → who can afford to keep creating.

Your impact → implication chain for creator income

Case 2 · a token claim (8 minutes). A fictional start-up says: “Tip creators with LoopCoin, our new token. Its value will rise as Loopline grows.” Using textbook p. 223 on cryptocurrencies and tokens, identify what the claim assumes and what could go wrong for a young creator paid in LoopCoin. This is an evaluation of a claim, not financial advice. Do not recommend buying or selling anything.

Assumptions in the claim and one risk to a creator

Case 3 · a learning platform (12 minutes). StudyStream, an invented school practice-video app, uses the same equation. It ranks practice videos by completion, topic match, freshness and novelty. Short, high-completion videos rise; long worked examples in a second language fall. Which learners gain, and which could lose access to what they need? Suggest one change to the variables or weights and say what it would cost.

Who gains and who loses on StudyStream, your change and its cost

Independent application · 15 minutes

Explain how a platform's revenue model can influence its ranking objective and redistribute visibility and opportunity. Use one Loopline figure and one real policy detail. Distinguish an immediate impact from a longer-term implication.

Before Thursday 15 October, read pp. 220–227 and pp. 31–32 for next week's quiz.

Evidence: impact → implication chains. Collected with the workbook, with focused feedback. No mark.

Reflection and next target

Name what you can now do, the evidence that shows it, and one precise next step.

One thing I can now explain accurately about recommendation systems, and where my evidence is

Help I used (Coach, partner, teacher) and what I decided independently

My next precise target and the fresh task that will show it

Reflection is your own evidence of learning. It is not a mark and does not replace your teacher's judgment.

What we are learning this week

Bomfim et al., *Digital Society*, Hodder, 2022. These are printed textbook pages. Use your licensed textbook for the complete material; the deck contains original explanations and new practice rather than reproduced pages.

Weekly reading: pp. 86–89, 72–74 and 213–219. Monday pp. 81–85 is prior-knowledge retrieval. These are parts of three chapters, not three whole chapters.

3.1H and start of 3.1I · pp. 72–74

3.1 Data and data analysis

Big data: four different questions

3.1H · pp. 72–74 · more rows cannot repair a missing population.

VOLUME

How much data?
20 complete rows / 200 partial rows

VELOCITY

How quickly is data generated?
One weekly batch / events each second

VARIETY

Which formats and sources?
Tables, video, text, device events

VERACITY

How accurate and representative?
Duplicates? Unknowns? Unseen people?

Original teaching schematic · Volume is amount; velocity is generation and processing speed; variety is formats and sources; veracity i

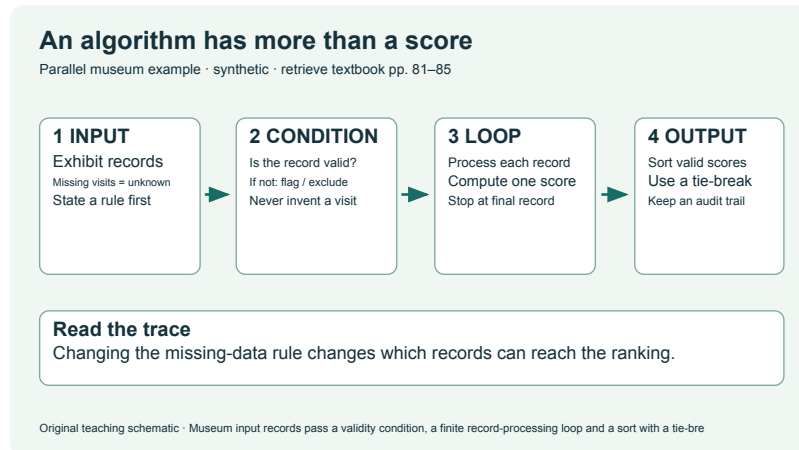
Volume is amount; velocity is generation and processing speed; variety is formats and sources; veracity is quality. The 20 and 200 row examples are synthetic.

Big data involves scale, speed, different formats and quality. Analytics processes data to find patterns that may inform decisions. Separate the size of a dataset from how well it represents the people affected. Page 74 begins data dilemmas at collection: necessity, consent and skew in who is represented.

- Volume ≠ veracity: 200 incomplete logs can offer weaker evidence than 20 complete relevant logs.
- A fast stream may require processing decisions before a human can inspect each event.
- A watch or skip is an observed action; preference and intention are interpretations.

Check without notes: You inherit 200 watch logs with no exposure records and 20 complete exposure/interaction records. Which question could each dataset answer? What can neither establish?

3.2 Algorithms and code



Museum input records pass a validity condition, a finite record-processing loop and a sort with a tie-break. Missing data must have a declared policy.

Retrieve input, output, sequence, condition, finite loop, search and sort. Then review algorithmic dilemmas: consistent automated decisions can improve efficiency while an inappropriate proxy, incomplete data or biased development can systematically skew results. Black-box opacity concerns how a result can be understood; accountability concerns who explains, corrects or takes responsibility. Publishing a rule does not make its outcomes fair.

- Trace a record through an actual condition and a stopping rule.
- Identify a biased sample or proxy separately from opacity.
- Use page 89's source-usefulness inquiry: origin, purpose, claims and limits.

Check without notes: A hypothetical recruitment tool ranks applicants by uninterrupted employment. Who might be disadvantaged, why, and what evidence would test that concern? Would making the score public solve it?

4.2 Economic

Digital business is a system of operations

4.2A · pp. 213–217 · classify the changed relationship, not the brand.

OPERATIONS

Transactions and inventory
Communication and analytics
Security / cost / human checks

DIVERSITY AT WORK

Whose skills are represented?
A historical proxy can exclude
Efficiency requires scrutiny

DIVERSIFICATION

Horizontal: complementary
Vertical: supply-chain stage
Concentric: wider audience

A fourth strategy: conglomerate diversification

A business enters an unrelated market. This differs from workforce diversity.
Example for classification: a search business investing in vehicle technology.
Prompt: where would a platform adding a creator shop fit — and why?

Original teaching schematic · Digital business includes transactions, inventory, communication and analytics

Digital business includes transactions, inventory, communication and analytics. Workforce diversity differs from horizontal, vertical, concentric and conglomerate diversification; examples are conceptual.

Review digital business operations (transactions, inventory, communication and analytics), business diversification, and workforce diversity and automated hiring. Horizontal diversification adds complementary products; vertical takes a supply-chain stage; concentric adapts related products to a wider audience; conglomerate enters an unrelated market. Diversity concerns people represented in a workforce. Digital work can be remote and mediated by platforms; benefits depend on access, security, bargaining power and the terms of work.

- Crowdsourcing seeks ideas or work; crowdfunding seeks money.
- Microwork is a small paid task; gig platforms match task-based services and demand.
- Sharing uses access to assets or services; it can overlap with a gig economy.
- Hiring efficiency, inclusive opportunity and applicant privacy may conflict.

Check without notes: A creator shop, a remote editor, a fundraising campaign and a platform matching one-off translation jobs: classify the business or work relationship and defend one trade-off. Do not sign up for a platform to do this task.

Revisit: Tuesday retrieve Monday's missing-data rule; Wednesday retrieve the changed ranking term; Thursday quiz includes four older-learning items; Friday apply Thursday feedback without notes; next d07 retrieve the loop and source limitation on a changed case. The Monday retry is a separate Sprint 2 identity/data-flow assessment.

Real cases: TikTok, YouTube and platform labour

Your commission: prepare a defensible briefing for a school digital-wellbeing group and student media team. They want to know whether a feed can improve discovery while respecting users and supporting creators. Choose a priority; support it with a mechanism and evidence. This classroom commission is invented. The TikTok investigation and YouTube policies below are real.

Case boundary: recommendation, user control and creator opportunity

TikTok describes a personalized recommendation system. In February 2026, the European Commission reported a preliminary finding concerning addictive design under the Digital Services Act, including a highly personalized recommender alongside other features. YouTube publishes policies for eligible creator revenue sharing. These establish different things: a provider account of a mechanism, a regulator's preliminary risk finding and a payment contract. They do not establish an individual creator's income or the causal effect of one design feature.

Inquiry: To what extent should a feed prioritize engagement rather than discovery, and what can the available evidence tell us about the consequences?

SOURCE A · 18 June 2020

How TikTok recommends videos #ForYou

TikTok Newsroom · [Read the primary source](#)

Assigned locator: Sections “What factors contribute to For You?” and “Diversifying recommendations”; locate the paragraph beginning “A strong indicator of interest...”

Paraphrased claim: The account groups signals into interactions, video information and device/account settings. It describes finishing a longer video as a stronger indicator than shared country, and acknowledges filter-bubble risk.

Origin, purpose and evidence: Official provider explanation of design; intended to explain and build trust. It is a primary account of what the provider states, not an independent measurement.

Relationship to another source: Compare its risk acknowledgement with C. Different dates and questions mean one cannot simply “prove” or “disprove” the other.

Limit: Historical description; exact current weights, individual experiences and independently measured harm are absent.

You decide: What exact sentence or section supports your chosen claim? Which part of your inquiry can this source answer?

SOURCE C · 6 February 2026

Commission preliminarily finds TikTok’s addictive design in breach of the Digital Services Act

European Commission · [Read the primary source](#)

Assigned locator: Opening finding and sections on addictive design/risk assessment; paragraph listing infinite scroll, autoplay, push notifications and the highly personalized recommender.

Paraphrased claim: The Commission reports a preliminary finding concerning addictive design. Its investigation considers scientific research, internal documents/data and expert interviews, among other evidence.

Origin, purpose and evidence: Official EU regulatory communication summarizing an investigation. It has a regulatory purpose and provides a bounded account, rather than raw study data for classroom re-analysis.

Relationship to another source: Relate its personalization concern to A’s description of signals and diversification. Separate acknowledged risks from demonstrated safeguards.

Limit: Preliminary, not final. Several design features are considered together. It does not isolate the recommender’s causal effect or establish worldwide creator income.

You decide: What exact sentence or section supports your chosen claim? Which part of your inquiry can this source answer?

SOURCE Y · Undated; checked 4 October 2026

YouTube partner earnings overview

YouTube Help · [Read the primary source](#)

Assigned locator: “How much does YouTube pay?” → ad revenue sharing: Watch Page Monetization Module and Shorts Monetization Module.

Paraphrased claim: The policy distinguishes 55% of net Watch Page ad revenue from 45% of a Shorts Creator Pool share allocated to the creator. Other earning routes include fan funding.

Origin, purpose and evidence: Platform policy/help page: useful for contractual bases and eligibility language; not a dataset on typical earnings.

Relationship to another source: Connect revenue eligibility and allocation to the exposure mechanism. More exposure alone does not prove paid or higher-valued views.

Limit: No guaranteed payment; different percentage bases; no individual earnings or distribution data.

You decide: What exact sentence or section supports your chosen claim? Which part of your inquiry can this source answer?

SOURCE L · 23 February 2021

Rapid growth of digital economy calls for coherent policy response

International Labour Organization · [Read the primary source](#)

Assigned locator: Opening summary and paragraphs describing digital labour platforms, workers and policy responses.

Paraphrased claim: The research summary situates platform work within a global digital economy and discusses opportunities and working-condition challenges.

Origin, purpose and evidence: ILO research communication based on its platform-work report; a broader labour lens than a provider's product description.

Relationship to another source: Use with A/Y to ask who performs work and who controls market access. It adds context, not TikTok-specific wage evidence.

Limit: Historical, cross-platform summary. Do not treat it as a 2026 survey of TikTok creators or infer current wages.

You decide: What exact sentence or section supports your chosen claim? Which part of your inquiry can this source answer?

Source passport and 3Cs

For A and C: record exact locator, supported claim, origin/date/purpose, evidence/method, corroboration, limitation and usefulness. Compare on one theme before writing a conclusion. These are paraphrase cards; open the original when exact wording matters. If blocked, use the attributed card and name the access limit.

Concept: choose power, systems, values and ethics, or expression. **Content:** identify the operation or data property that matters. **Context:** explain why a school user, EU regulator, advertiser and creator may judge the same outcome differently. Compare two stakeholders' goals and actual control.

[Passport worksheet](#) · [Paper 2 comparison questions](#)

Paper 1 and Paper 2: explicit practice

Original classroom practice: these questions mirror Paper 1's 6/6/8 and Paper 2's 2/4/6/12 progression. They are partial practice, not a full paper, registered score or predicted grade. Keep the registered Thursday quiz /12 and original d05 paragraph separate.

[Source A](#) · [Source C](#) · Choose the task released by your teacher; do not complete all seven this week.

Paper 1: knowledge → application → judgement

P1a · FORMATIVE PRACTICE

Outline two components used in an algorithm that ranks short videos. [6]

AO1 rehearsal · Monday oral/notes, 3–5 minutes inside guided practice. Resources: no notes first, then chapter correction.

Your independent response

► After feedback

P1b · FORMATIVE PRACTICE

Explain how changing a recommendation objective from engagement to discovery could change the visibility of creators. Use your trace and a specific stakeholder. [6]

AO2 partial practice · Tuesday visibility phase of the lab, up to 8 minutes. Use your own paper trace. Record relevant reasoning in d03-visibility; preserve the later 15-minute original feedback-loop response.

Your independent response

► After feedback

P1c · FORMATIVE PRACTICE

Evaluate the claim that making recommendation algorithms more transparent is sufficient to address risks to users. Refer to the TikTok case and a counter-perspective. [8]

AO3 extension after this week, not an extra Thursday assessment. Teacher assigns conditions before use.

Your independent response

► After feedback

Paper 2: sources → comparison → synthesis

P2q1 · FORMATIVE PRACTICE

Identify two types of input signal described in Source A. [2]

Friday inquiry, about 2 minutes. Use Source A.

Your independent response

► After feedback

P2q2 · FORMATIVE PRACTICE

Using Source A and your knowledge, explain two ways the exposure–interaction feedback loop could influence later recommendations. [4]

Friday inquiry, about 5 minutes. Use sources and your mechanism knowledge.

Your independent response

► After feedback

P2q3 · FORMATIVE PRACTICE

Compare and contrast Sources A and C regarding personalization and risk. Explain one similarity and one difference using specific source details, and consider their scope or evidence. [6]

Friday inquiry, 8–10 minutes. Use both source cards; locate the supporting sections.

Your independent response

► After feedback

P2q4 · FORMATIVE PRACTICE

Evaluate the claim that giving users greater control over their feeds is likely to address the main risks of personalized recommendation. Use Sources A and C and your own knowledge. [12]

Later d07 synthesis extension; not added to this week's 350 minutes. Teacher sets time and conditions before use.

Your independent response

► After feedback

Optional responses stay in this browser under a separate practice key.

Teacher review draft · 5–9 October 2026 · Original practice, not an official IB examination. No publication or submission occurs from this file.